Competitive Analysis

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The Problem

Many older adults in America who use traditional, herbal, and complementary health practices struggle with an information gap due to a lack of credible sources that provide trustworthy, relevant, and easy-to-understand information about these practices. Further, the scope of usage of nonconventional healthcare practices is large: according to a report from the National Center for Complementary and Integrative Health (NCCIH), approximately 37% of adult residents of the United States utilize at least one complementary or integrative health option. Additionally, according to CDC research, approximately 17.9% of adults in the US used non-vitamin or herbal therapies in 2012. However, it is important to note that numbers reported above represent a broader range of complementary practices and can't represent the usage of every culturally rooted remedy. But without access to reliable information about ingredients, their effectiveness, safety, and potential drug interactions, it can be difficult for people to evaluate the remedies they use. This problem relates to the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goal 3, which focuses on ensuring healthy lives and promoting well-being for all.

The information gap is particularly important for people who encounter problems with conventional healthcare. For example, costs can cause hesitation even for people with insurance. A KFF survey found that 28% of U.S. adults skipped or postponed needed health care in the past year because of cost. Distrust can come from personal experiences with the health care system, from stories shared in a community, or from feeling dismissed when mentioning a traditional remedy to a provider. Pew describes institutional distrust as one reason some Americans avoid care until they feel they have no other choice. Delaying care can seem like the easier choice at first, but it can make things worse. In the KFF survey, 15% of adults said their health got worse because they skipped or delayed care, rising to 27% among adults with multiple health conditions. Cultural beliefs and personal preference matter too, since many people feel more comfortable using a practice their family has relied on for generations than an unfamiliar medication. Existing resources do not meet these people where they are. The NCCIH offers evidence-based information, but

it focuses largely on herbs and dietary supplements and advises talking with a health care provider, which may not help someone who is avoiding care because they don't trust it or can't afford it. The WHO's Global Centre for Traditional Medicine is aimed at research, governments, and policy, not simple guidance for individuals at home. Most conventional health resources focus on biomedical treatment and say little about practices from different cultures.

This leaves a real gap. Someone may have heard of a traditional remedy without knowing how to prepare it, where to find the ingredients, what its benefits and risks are, or whether it is safe alongside their medications. The NCCIH warns that supplements can interact with prescription drugs and that some products have been found to contain hidden drugs. Without a trusted source, people end up relying on random online searches or secondhand advice. The problem isn't that people don't care about their health. They lack a trustworthy, culturally respectful, privacy conscious source that explains traditional remedies honestly, flags safety concerns, and tells them when it is time to seek professional care.

The Market

Our primary users are U.S. adults who already use, or want to use, home and traditional remedies from their own cultural background (initially Indian, Native, Muslim, and Black/African traditions) and who delay or avoid conventional care because of cost, distrust, or comfort with familiar practices. Based on our problem statement, this includes the roughly 28% of adults who skipped or postponed care for cost reasons and people whose low confidence in the medical system (36% report a great deal of confidence) leads them to try home care first.

Secondary users include adults managing chronic conditions or taking prescription medications, who face the most risk from supplement interactions and delayed care, caregivers and younger family members who want to learn remedies from elders; and members of diaspora communities reconnecting with the practices of their roots. Because the app is privacy-focused and does not require medical records, it also fits people who are uninsured or underinsured and want trustworthy information before deciding whether to seek care.

The Competitors

In the table below, include information for at least five companies or organizations. Include both direct and indirect competitors. Because we are addressing serious issues, these may be NGOs or government organizations. [You can present this information in a different way than a table if you prefer, as long as all fields are present.]

Direct competitors. These companies or organizations offer similar products or services to what we plan to build.

Indirect competitors. These companies or organizations offer alternative solutions to the same problem.

	Comp 1	Comp 2	Comp 3	Comp 4	Comp 5
Name	Home Remedies & Natural Cure	Natural Medicines / NatMed Pro	National Center for Complementary and Integrative Health	WHO Global Centre for Traditional Medicine	Ada Health
Target Customers	General consumers, mainly in India and the Indian diaspora, who want quick Ayurvedic home remedies for common ailments.	Pharmacists, physicians, and other clinicians, universities and health systems, some individual consumers through an app.	The general public, health care providers, and researchers	Governments, policymakers, researchers, and national health systems.	Individual consumers worldwide, plus health systems, insurers, and employers (enterprise clients).
Year Founded	2015	1985	1991	2022	2011
Strengths	Free and easy to use. Covers about 100	ratings for over 1,400 natural ingredients and therapies.	Free, and science-based. fact sheets on herbs,	Global credibility and reach. Builds research and data on	AI-powered symptom assessment built

	common conditions	Multi-languages	supplements, and practices. Clear warnings about interactions and unsafe products.	traditional medicine across many countries.	with doctors
Weaknesses	Single tradition + no guidance on when to seek professional help	Paywalled subscription with little cultural context or credit to the traditions behind remedies.	Focuses mostly on herbs and supplements, not whole cultural practices.	Aimed at research and policy, not simple guidance individuals can use at home.	Biomedical only and does not include traditional or cultural remedies.
Mission	No mission found	Provide evidence-based information on dietary supplements, natural medicines, and complementary and integrative therapies for use in patient care.	Define, through rigorous scientific investigation, the usefulness and safety of complementary and integrative health approaches and their role in improving health and health care.	Harness the potential of traditional medicine from around the world through science and technology to improve the health of people and the planet.	Improve human health by turning medical knowledge into better outcomes.
Services or Product	Mobile app with an alphabetical list of about 100 remedies by condition.	Subscription database with interaction checker, effectiveness checker, safety ratings, commercial product ratings, and patient handouts.	Website with health fact sheets, a clearinghouse, newsletters, and federally funded research.	Research programs, data and evidence building, standards, and policy support for member states.	Free symptom checker app that suggests possible conditions and next steps, plus enterprise triage tools.

Work Cited

KFF.

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Pew Charitable Trusts

https://www.pew.org/en/trend/archive/fall-2024/from-distrust-to-confidence-can-science-and-health-care-gain-whats-missing

World Health Organization.

https://www.who.int/news/item/25-03-2022-who-establishes-the-global-centre-for-traditional-medicine-in-india

NCCIH (new)

https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/are-you-considering-a-complementary-health-approach

https://www.nccih.nih.gov/about/the-national-center-for-complementary-and-integrative-health-nccih-supporting-research-on-the-whole-person

https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/safety

https://www.nccih.nih.gov/health/providers/digest/herb-drug-interactions

CDC (new)
https://www.cdc.gov/pcd/issues/2016/15_0501.htm